

Vocabulary UX review

Inline definitions, linked terms, and the searchable Vocabulary panel

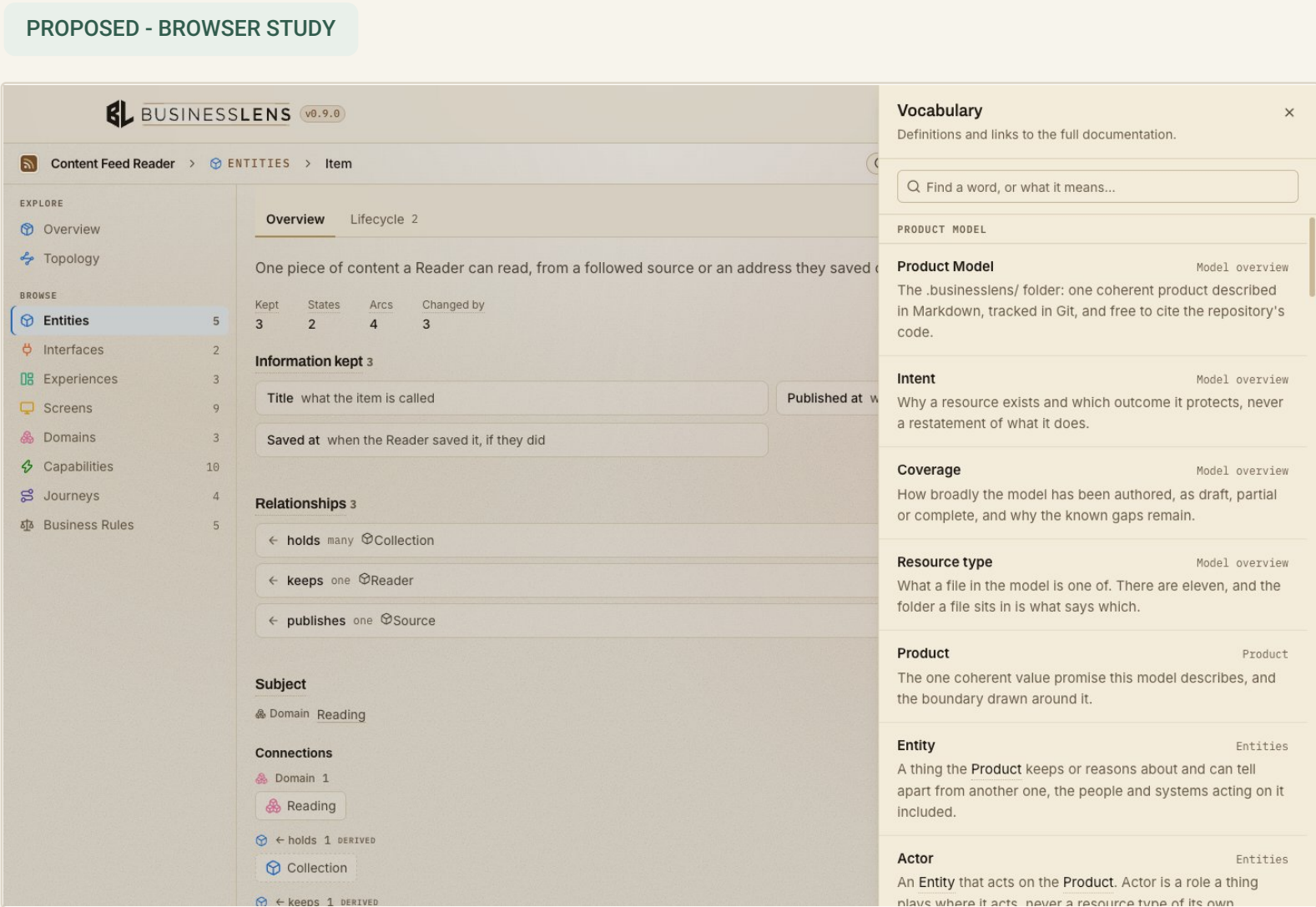
Make every lookup feel close at hand.

The foundation works. Give definitions more room, keep the report visually present, and preserve the reader's place through every lookup.

First: correct the panel gutters and proportions.

Next: fix search position, ranking, and focus.

Then: complete mobile access and backtracking.



A 480px panel with aligned gutters and a lighter backdrop. The report remains recognizable behind the lookup.

SCOPE

Two local commits ahead of origin/main. Only vocabulary-related UI.

EVIDENCE

Chrome DevTools MCP, screenshots, DOM measurements, and source review.

STATUS

Recommendations and temporary browser styles. No source changes implemented.

Give the vocabulary a proper reading column.

A modest increase in width works best with consistent padding and a quieter overlay.

CURRENT - 448px

Vocabulary

Selected Product Model and report terms, with the page that defines each one.

Find a word, or what it means...

PRODUCT MODEL

Product Model

Model overview

The .businesslens/ folder: one coherent product described in Markdown, tracked in Git, and free to cite the repository's code.

Intent

Model overview

Why a resource exists and which outcome it protects, never a restatement of what it does.

Coverage

Model overview

How broadly the model has been authored, as draft, partial or complete, and why the known gaps remain.

Resource type

Model overview

What a file in the model is one of. There are eleven, and the folder a file sits in is what says which.

Product

Product

The one coherent value promise this model describes, and the boundary drawn around it.

PROPOSED - 480px

Vocabulary

Definitions and links to the full documentation.

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01

Recover the usable width

Desktop applies 24px body padding around rows with another 16px inset. Replace the combined 40px text gutter with one 20px gutter.

02

Keep the report in view

The current 75% tinted overlay almost erases the underlying page. A much lighter backdrop preserves the sense of a quick reference alongside the reading.

03

Establish a shared left edge

Align the title, search field, group label, and row text. Remove the large blank band above the search field.

Equal screenshot scale. Proposed preview uses 480px width, 20px gutters, 15px definitions, and 14% neutral dimming in light mode.

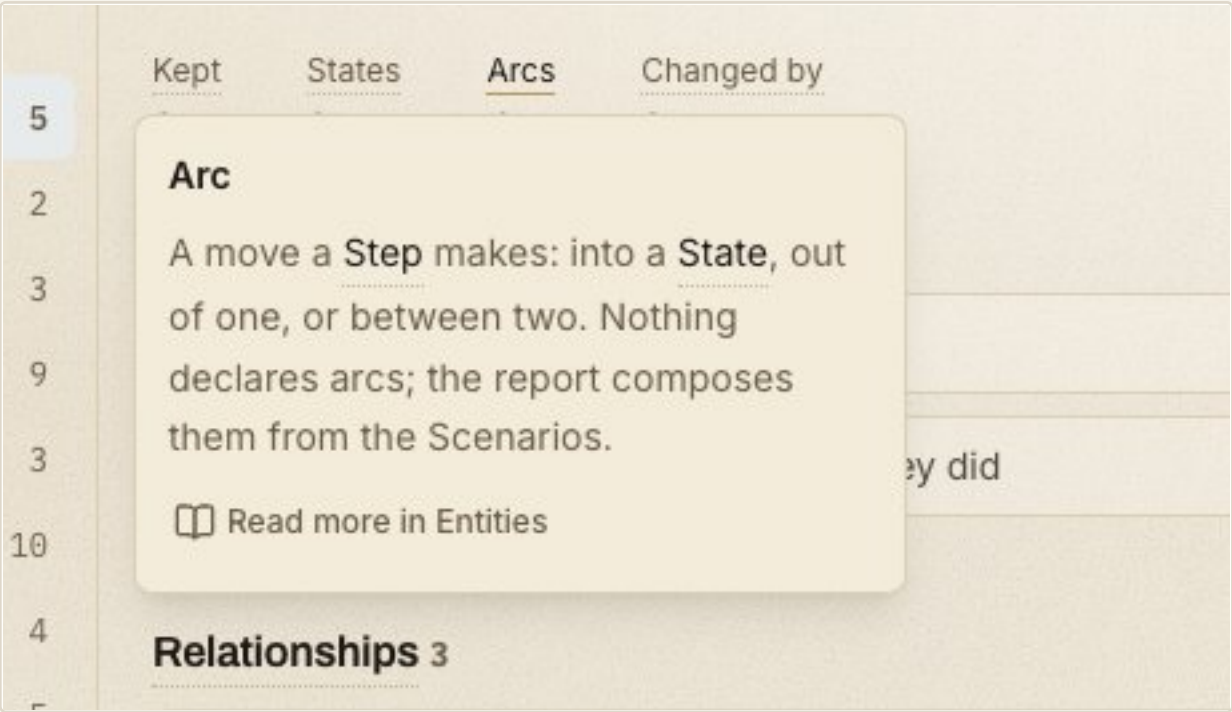
VOCABULARY UX REVIEW / LOCAL COMMITS 680369e + 9d00171

02 / 08

Give the definition a little breathing room.

The local answer should stay compact, legible, and visibly attached to its trigger.

CURRENT - 288px / 12px PADDING



PROPOSED - 336px / 16px PADDING



- Use 336px as the default

Cap the width at the viewport minus 32px. Let content determine height; avoid internal scrolling for these short definitions.

Keep the 14px body text

The current text size is readable. Increase space around it and keep the documentation action visually secondary.

Retain the local interaction

Keep the dotted trigger and click-to-open behavior. Maintain collision handling so edge-of-screen popovers remain visible.

The wider example improves spacing; it does not reduce line count for every definition. Both images use the same crop and scale.

Use the full screen well on mobile.

Keep the full-width panel. Spend its limited space on search and readable definitions.

CURRENT - 390px VIEWPORT

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Selected Product Model and report terms, with the page that defines each one.

Q Find a word, or what it means...

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Product

Product

The one coherent value promise this model describes, and the boundary drawn around it.

Entity

Entities

A thing the Product keeps or reasons about and can tell apart from another one, the people and systems acting on it included.

Actor

Entities

An Entity that acts on the Product. Actor is a role a thing plays where it acts, never a resource type of its

PROPOSED - 390px VIEWPORT

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Definitions and links to the full documentation.

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01

Make search easier to tap

Increase the field from 28px to 44px high. Use 16px input text and a 44px close target in the mobile layout.

02

Compress the introduction

Use "Definitions and links to the full documentation." Keep the search fixed above the independently scrolling list.

03

Use 16px side gutters

Full width gives the text the room it needs. The 15px definition text and 23px line height trade a little density for easier reading.

ALSO COMPLETE THE INTERACTION

The mobile collection title is plain text. Give "Interfaces" the same definition action as its desktop equivalent.

A concrete starting point for the next pass.

These are proposed design values, informed by the browser study, rather than shipped behavior.

ELEMENT	CURRENT	PROPOSED	REASON
Definition popover	288px width; 12px padding	336px width; 16px padding	More breathing room; retain 14px text.
Panel width	448px desktop	480px desktop; full width on mobile	A readable column, about one-third of a 1440px viewport.
Panel spacing	40px text inset on desktop. 10px vertical row padding.	20px desktop; 16px mobile. 14px vertical row padding.	One shared left edge for title, search, and rows.
Panel typography	16px title; 14px definitions	18px title; 15px definitions / 23px line height	Clearer hierarchy and paragraph reading.
Search field	28px high	36px desktop; 44px mobile	A stronger primary action and easier tapping.
Introduction	A two-line description	One short sentence	Reduce the space before the actual lookup.
Backdrop	75% tinted overlay	Subtle, theme-aware dimming	Preserve the context of the report.

Responsive limits

Popover: no wider than viewport - 32px. Panel: no wider than viewport. Keep the header and search visible while the list scrolls.

Theme validation still required

The light preview uses 14% neutral dimming. Recheck the backdrop, separators, and focused term in dark mode before adopting it.

Make the requested word the first thing seen.

Two reproducible issues interrupt a basic lookup: result ordering and retained scroll position.

OBSERVED - SEARCH "STEP"

Q StepX

PRODUCT MODEL

ArcEntities

A move a Step makes: into a State, out of one, or between two. Nothing declares arcs; the report composes them from the Scenarios.

LifecycleEntities

The machine composed from every arc in the model. Nobody authors it; it is derived from the Steps.

Changed byEntities

The Capabilities whose Steps create, change, or remove this thing.

Capability ScenarioCapabilities

One observable acceptance case for a Capability: a trigger, typed Steps, and an outcome.

StepCapabilities

One act in a Scenario: an Actor's, the Product's own, or a condition that holds. Each says what it does to the Product's things.

Ends withCapabilities

Where a Scenario leaves each thing it changed, from the last Step that named it.

RouteCapabilities

One named way the same Steps play out in different

OBSERVED - SEARCH "PRODUCT"

Q ProductX

PRODUCT MODEL

DomainDomains

What a Capability or Entity is about, in the Product's own words. One Domain reaches everything on that subject, which is why it earns a place.

BoundaryDomains

What a Domain takes in and what it leaves out, stated in the Product's own words.

CapabilityCapabilities

A durable ability of the Product: what it can do, independent of any one route, command, or module.

StepCapabilities

One act in a Scenario: an Actor's, the Product's own, or a condition that holds. Each says what it does to the Product's things.

CLI

Product Reportblueprint export

The serialization of a Product Model. One format, two profiles: workspace keeps repository navigation, portable carries none of it.

Blueprintblueprint contribute

A Product Report curated into the public catalog under a slug. Always the portable profile, because that is what the catalog accepts.

FIX BEFORE SHIPPING

01 Exact matches should lead

Searching "Step" returns its definition fifth, below four definitions that mention steps.

Change: rank exact names first, partial names second, and definition matches third. Keep ties deterministic.

02 New searches need a fresh position

Search Arc, follow Step, then search Product. The list retains a scroll offset and the Step highlight; Product is above the visible area.

Change: reset list scrolling and clear the prior marked term when the reader types a new query.

Keep the reader's place through every lookup.

The report URL survives the lookup; keyboard focus and the lookup trail need the same care.

OBSERVED KEYBOARD BUG

Closing Vocabulary loses focus

Interfaces definition > Actors > Escape > Tab



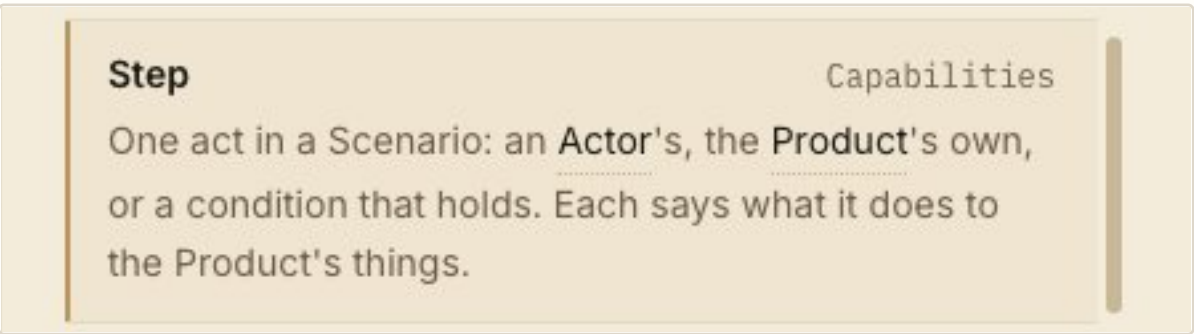
After dismissal, focus falls to the page body. The next Tab starts at the site logo, shown above.

Fix: remember the original definition trigger and restore focus to it after the panel closes.

RECOMMENDED NAVIGATION IMPROVEMENT

Give linked definitions a way back

Search Arc > follow Step > return to Arc



Following Step clears the search and jumps into the full list. There is no control to restore the previous lookup.

Improve: offer "Back to Arc" and restore the previous query, scroll position, and focused term.

ONE SMALL FOCUS IMPROVEMENT

When Vocabulary opens from the desktop header, focus search rather than Close. When it opens for a specific term, keep the existing term focus. Decide mobile autofocus separately to avoid opening the keyboard unnecessarily.

Turn the review into three bounded changes.

Keep the implementation within the vocabulary surfaces introduced by the two local commits.

01

Layout and visual hierarchy

Apply panel gutters, width, typography, search height, and shorter copy. Adjust the popover width and padding. Validate the lighter backdrop in both themes.

BlrVocabulary.vue / BlrTerm.vue

02

Search and focus reliability

Rank exact matches first. Reset search scroll and marked state. Restore the originating trigger after a linked lookup. Focus general desktop lookups in search.

vocabulary.ts / useVocabularyPanel.ts

03

Continuity and mobile access

Add a small lookup history for returning to a previous term. Reuse the definition trigger on the mobile collection title.

BlrVocabulary.vue / BlrReportShell.vue

ACCEPTANCE CHECKS

Reading	At desktop and 390px widths, definitions fit, search stays visible, and no panel or popover clips horizontally.
Search	Step is first for "Step". After Arc > Step, searching Product starts at the top with no stale highlight.
Keyboard	Enter opens a definition. Escape closes it. After a linked lookup, focus returns to the original report trigger.
Continuity	Back restores the prior lookup. Closing the panel preserves the report page. Mobile collection titles offer definitions.

Evidence and limits. Current UI was inspected with Chrome DevTools MCP using the Content Feed Reader model, desktop and mobile viewports, and both themes. Proposed images are temporary browser studies; the new styling has not been implemented or fully regression-tested. The docs website and earlier release UX are outside this review.